EDWARD SHIRLEY

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EDUCATION

University College London | MSc Computational Finance | (*In progress)* **2026 - 2027**

- Relevant Modules: Probability Theory and Stochastic Processes, Numerical Methods for Finance, Advanced Machine Learning in Finance, Applied Computational Finance, Research Computing with C++, Financial Engineering

University of Exeter | **BSc (Hons) Accounting and Finance |** ***(1st Class with Honours)*** **2023 - 2026**

- Relevant Modules: Advanced Mathematics for Economists (*84%*), Machine Learning for Economics (*84%*), Futures and Options (72%)
- **Awards: Dean's Commendations for Exceptional Performance (In both years 2 & 3)**

PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

Competitions

IMC Prosperity IV *(solo, ~18,000 participants)*: **April 2026**

- Joint 1st worldwide on Round 1 Manual auction challenge. Built a custom object-orientated log-file parser with visual analytics; Identified and exploited a pair of offsetting bots posting orders several standard deviations from fair value.

Fullhouse Hackathon: **June 2026**

- Built an adaptive poker bot using gradient-boosting opponent modelling and iterative self-play strategy refinement inspired by AlphaGo's training pipeline to take into account both board state and individual player behaviours.

Projects

US CPI forecasting *(FRED-MD):* **Dec 2025 - Jan 2026**

- Compared 12 models on a 1959–2025 monthly panel and avoided temporal data leakage; Elastic Net/Lasso outperformed baseline by ~23% MSE and selected 13–14 features. Tree models matched average error but collapsed in volatile periods as they anchored to the training mean

WORK EXPERIENCE

Summer Analyst, Broad Reach Investment Management, London **Jul 2025**

(EM macro hedge fund, $2.6bn AUM)

- Developed a momentum-based trading strategy using moving average derivatives to identify trend reversals; approach validated by quantitative team independently developing similar methodology
- Analysed monetary policy, growth outlook, and inflation, to assess investment opportunities in the firm's specialised EM portfolio

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills

- Programming Languages (Object Oriented): Python: NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, matplotlib | C++
- Mathematics: Linear Algebra, Probability Theory, Real Analysis, Stochastic Calculus

Sailing Instructor, Sutton Bingham Sailing Club, Yeovil **2017 - 2023**

- Led a team of instructors to assist in teaching students

Marine Conservation Society Part-time Volunteer, Bridport, Dorset **Jul - Sep, 2025 - 2026**

- Documented observations of marine species and coastal habitats to support conservation research efforts along Lyme Bay

Hobbies: Scuba diving, Free diving, Sailing

Societies: UCL AI Society, UCL Poker Society